

ID.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document you will meet, named as the agency names it — and the things Idaho never asks you for.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Idaho's Building Code Act does not put a private house under a building permit by itself — it authorizes each city and county to adopt and enforce a code, and where none has, there is no residential building permit, plan review, inspection or certificate of occupancy. The state Division of Occupational and Professional Licenses (DOPL) issues no building permit for a house. What does not depend on any of that: the electrical, plumbing and HVAC permits, which are statewide; the health-district septic permit; and the IDWR well drilling permit. The unit is the **jurisdiction** — a city inside a county routinely differs from the county around it. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it. Form names, revision dates and fees were read from the agencies' own current forms in September 2026. Where no form number is published, this document says so rather than inventing one.

THE STATE DOCUMENTS

What the state and its districts issue, and what it costs

Document	What it is	Fee
Application for Homeowner Permit — Electrical DOPL, rev. 9/13/2022	The homeowner's own electrical permit. "As of January 1, 2023, all permits will need to be purchased Online at DBS.IDAHO.GOV" — the paper form shows you the fields and the certification you will click through. "This permit application is not an inspection request"	\$130-\$325 by living space; \$65 per inspection on an existing dwelling
Application for Homeowner Permit — Plumbing, with the Plumbing Permit Worksheet DOPL, rev. 8/17/2022	Same certification. The worksheet is the fee schedule and carries the definition that matters: living space "utilized for sleeping, eating, cooking, bathing, washing, recreation, and sanitation purposes. An unfinished basement is considered part of the living space"	\$130-\$325 by living space; \$65 sewer and water lines if inspected together
Application for Homeowner Permit — HVAC, with the Homeowner HVAC Permit Fee Schedule DOPL, rev. 8/17/2022	Same certification. The fee schedule is where the Manual S, J and D review line lives — "required when installing the primary heating and/or cooling system in a NEW single or two-family dwelling" — so the load, equipment and duct calculations travel with the application	\$100 base + per appliance and duct; \$25 review

What the state and its districts issue, and what it costs

Document	What it is	Fee
Job Identification Sticker DOPL	The orange sticker that marks the permitted job site; print one with an online permit and the inspector replaces it on the first visit. Yellow is a Correction Sticker. An Enforcement Permit — issued only by an inspector, only for work done without a permit — costs double	Included with the permit
Plan Review Application DOPL, rev. 9/12/2023	Not yours — printed here because it is the document that settles the central question: "DOPL does NOT issue building permits for projects not owned by the State. Contact the local government for these projects"	—
Individual and Subsurface System Installation Permit Public health district	The septic permit, by the rule's own name (IDAPA 58.01.03.005.07). Invalid if not "completed and approved within two (2) years" (005.08). Ends with the district's as-built drawing , sent to you within 30 days of the final (011.05) — keep it with the deed	\$400 minimum; \$300 tank only; \$40 renewal (58.01.14.110.04); districts may differ
Drilling permit — and the Start Card IDWR	Required "prior to beginning construction of any well" (§ 42-235). The rules define a "Start Card" as "an expedited drilling permit process for the construction of cold water, single-family residential wells" (IDAPA 37.03.09.010.49) — ask the driller which route applies	\$75 domestic
Well driller's report IDWR	The driller's log and report, filed "within thirty (30) days following the completion of the well" (§ 42-238(11)). Searchable afterwards in IDWR's well-log search. Get a copy — it is the well's only record	Filed by the driller
Property condition disclosure form § 55-2508	Required on a sale of a 1-4 unit residence — but a never-inhabited new house is exempt except for "annexation and city service status" (§ 55-2505(12)). Live in it first and the whole form applies later, including whether work was done "without a building permit"	At sale

The certification on all three homeowner forms, verbatim: "I certify that I am the owner of the residential property and will personally perform the work covered by this permit. I recognize this permit is only valid for work on a primary or secondary residence and associated outbuildings not used for commercial purposes or rented by a tenant. By signing this, I accept responsibility for all the work being performed, and understand that all work must be inspected by the Division of Occupational and Professional Licensing." Nothing about sale. Nothing about lease.

THE LOCAL DOCUMENTS — IF THEY EXIST WHERE YOU ARE

In an enforcing jurisdiction the city or county issues its own paperwork under its own names, and there is no statewide vocabulary for it. Write in what yours calls them.

What my jurisdiction calls each document

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Permit-process document under § 39-4117(1) — the one that proves a building code is enforced. Where I found it: Location / URL _____		
☐	Building permit application , and whether there is a separate homeowner or owner-builder version: Called _____ Separate form? _____		
☐	Contractor-registration exemption declaration. No state form exists; the statute requires only "no contractor registration provided" on the permit face (§ 54-5209). Mine is called: Called _____		
☐	Zoning or land-use permit , if separate: Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Driveway approach / encroachment permit: Called _____ Road authority _____		
☐	911 address application: Called _____ Issued by _____		
☐	Floodplain development permit , if in a mapped hazard area: Called _____ Administrator _____		
☐	Certificate of occupancy — ask whether one is issued, because where no code is enforced there is none: Answer _____		

WHAT NEEDS NO PERMIT AT ALL

Building — only meaningful in an enforcing jurisdiction, and Part I is locally amendable, so confirm. Idaho keeps IRC R105.2's list and amends two items (IDAPA 24.39.30.600.03.b-c):

IRC R105.2 as Idaho adopted it

What	The condition
Accessory structures	One-story detached, not over 200 sq ft
Fences, walls	Fences not over 7 ft; retaining walls not over 4 ft unless supporting a surcharge
Pools	Prefabricated pools "less than four (4) feet " deep — Idaho replaced the model code's 24 inches
Flag poles	Added by Idaho as item 11
Decks, walks, drives, paint	Decks not over 200 sq ft and not more than 30 in above grade; sidewalks and driveways; painting, papering, tiling, cabinets, counters

Trades — statewide. Plumbing: no permit "for the clearing of stoppages or repairing of leaks" with no rearrangement of pipes or fixtures (§ 54-2621). HVAC: "no permit shall be required to perform work related to repair or maintenance of an existing HVAC system" (§ 54-5016(1)). Electrical: **no equivalent** — the chapter has no repair exception and no farm-building exception. **Agricultural buildings** are exempt from the building codes, but "a place of human habitation, which means a space in a building for living, sleeping, or cooking" is not an agricultural building (§ 39-4116(5)), and the plumbing and HVAC farm-building exceptions carry the same carve-out.

WHAT IDAHO DOES NOT REQUIRE

Worth knowing because owner-builders arriving from other states routinely budget for these. In Idaho none of them is mandatory — and on the first four no city or county may add them.

- **Residential fire sprinklers.** Exempted by statute for one- and two-family dwellings; R313.2 deleted from the code (§ 39-4116(3)).
- **A blower-door test.** "A visual inspection shall be considered acceptable in lieu of testing" — the permit holder chooses at application (IDAPA 24.39.30.600.06.e). No local energy requirement may differ from the state code (§ 39-9701(2)).
- **Whole-house AFCI, a surge-protective device, an outdoor emergency disconnect.** AFCI applies to bedroom circuits only; the SPD and the emergency disconnect "shall be permitted" (IDAPA 24.39.10.600.01.k, .n, .o, .r).
- **EV charging infrastructure.** Neither the state nor any local government may require a charging station, EV parking space or upgraded conduit in a building plan (§ 39-4109B).
- **A "not for sale, rent or lease" affidavit.** The words are on no statute, rule or form. The DOPL certification is "will personally perform the work" and "not used for commercial purposes or rented by a tenant."
- **A statewide snow load, frost depth or seismic category.** None exists; IRC R301 design criteria are the county's to set (§ 39-4116(4)(c)(iii)). The one statewide depth is the

42-inch water-service cover (IDAPA 24.39.20.600.21).

- **A residential building permit from the state.** DOPL issues none. Where no local code is adopted, there is no building permit to apply for.

One thing Idaho does require that other states do not: whole-house mechanical ventilation in every new dwelling, whatever the air-leakage result (IDAPA 24.39.30.600.03.h). And a pre-plumbed water softener loop in every new house on a slab or with a finished basement (IDAPA 24.39.20.600.26).

THE ONE THING YOU MAY NOT DO YOURSELF

Idaho is generous about owner-performed work. You may act as your own contractor, wire your own house, do your own plumbing and HVAC on homeowner permits, and install your own standard septic system. **You may not drill your own well.**

The definition that closes the door

"It shall be unlawful for any person to drill a well in Idaho, including wells excepted under sections 42-227 and 42-228, Idaho Code, without first complying with the provisions of this chapter" (§ 42-238(2)) — and "a 'person' shall be defined as **any individual who drills or abandons any well for himself or another** in this state" (§ 42-238(3)). The chapter then requires a driller's license, an examination, references and a bond. IDWR's own page: "All wells must be constructed by a well driller with a valid license from IDWR." Contrast the septic rule, which says in so many words that an installer's permit "is not required for ... owners installing their own standard or basic alternative system" (IDAPA 58.01.03.006.08.b). The well is the exception, and it is written without one.

Everything cited here is free to read. Statutes are at legislature.idaho.gov → Idaho Statutes, one section per page (.../idstat/Title54/T54CH10/SECT54-1016/), each ending with a History line naming every session law that amended it. Rules are at adminrules.idaho.gov, one PDF per IDAPA chapter (.../rules/current/24/243910.pdf), every paragraph carrying its own effective date. **One warning:** DOPL is not your building department — its own form says so. Read September 2026.